citizenship) and the Sirimavo-Shastri Pact, 1964 (regarding repatriation of 5,25,000 stateless people to India and granting of Sri Lankan citizenship to 3,00,000 Tamils.) However, with the escalation of Tamil insurgency and subsequent suppression by the Sri Lankan Government, India had to take notice of the situation in 1983. A large number of Tamils left Sri Lanka and crossed over to India, and created refugee problem in 1984–85. Under such circumstances, there was a strong demand from the Tamil Nadu state government on the intervention of the Indian Government. India however, resisted from such intervention and pressed the Sri Lankan Government for finding out a political situation.

Around May-June 1987, India responded in the wake of large scale massacre of Tamils in Jaffna by security forces of Sri Lanka Government. India air-dropped humanitarian assistance to the suffering Tamils. This created tension in the Indo-Sri Lanka relation as Sri Lanka viewed it as an interference/intervention by India. However, things started showing improvement with the signing of an accord between the then Indian Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi and Sri Lankan President Jayewardane on 29 July 1987. Relations eased after the accord. India sent the Indian Peace-keeping Force (IPKF) for fulfillment of the obligations under the accord. India assumed the responsibility of disarming the Tamil militants, but very soon troubles began to emerge. The LTTE refused to surrender arms and engaged in violence against other Tamils preferring to contest provincial elections. The IPKF also got embroiled in many controversies like human rights violations and its presence on the Sri Lankan soil started to be protested by Sri Lankans. Even Sri Lankan President Premadasa wanted India to recall the IPKF and as a protest Sri Lankan Foreign Minister did not participate in the meeting of Foreign Ministers of SAARC held in 1989. Ultimately, the IPKF was withdrawn in 1990. In 1992, following the SAARC Summit President Premadasa taking advantage of India’s absence left no room for pouring out his bitter feeling against India. He even held informal talks with Pakistan, Bangladesh and Maldives where he displayed open hostility against India.

However, relations again became normal in 1992. By July 1992, more than 23,000 of Tamil refugees in India were repatriated.